

ACCT 3220 Corporate Financial Reporting 1: Fall 2025
(updated as of: September 23, 2025)

Professor: Jeremiah Contreras, jeremiah.contreras@colorado.edu

My Office: KOBL 464B or 467

Office Hours: See Canvas for Office Hours

Course Sections:

Section	Class Time	Room #
004	M/W 2:00 PM – 3:15 PM	KOBL 105

Course Learning Objectives:

By the end of this course, you will:

- Deepen your understanding of current U.S. GAAP (Generally Accepted Accounting Principles)
- Analyze corporate annual reports and financial statements
- Gain in-depth knowledge of specific accounting principles
- Understand how accounting principles affect financial statement information
- Explore the incentives and discretion in accounting practices

This course will support your future accounting and finance studies, as well as your professional career.

Course Materials:

Required textbook: **Hanlon, Hodder, Nelson, Roulstone, Dragoo, Intermediate Accounting Vol 1 & 2, 4e, 2026**. To keep the cost of your course materials as low as possible and access to those materials as convenient as possible, we have collaborated with the CU Book Store and the publisher to deliver those materials through CU Book Access / Inclusive Access.

- You will receive access to all your course materials, digitally, on the first day of classes, through the course Canvas page.
- The e-book and other resources are included as part of the single semester, flat fee of \$259 (plus tax) that covers all your courses.
- If you opt out of the CU Book Access flat fee, you can purchase the e-book and other resources for \$130 (one semester) or \$160 (two semesters, if you will want to access it for Corp 2 ACCT-3230). This is a guaranteed lowest price, discounted by the publisher, and not available outside this course. This option provides all eResources (MyBusinessCourse and the eBook).
- If you opt out of CU Book Access and do not purchase the e-book, you lose all access to the course materials, including the homework manager. Please keep in mind that “opting out” means that your access to these materials will be turned off and you will have **no way to complete the homework assignments**. You can opt out of the CU Book Access by the last day to drop a course without penalty.
- If you would like a hard copy in addition to the digital copy/access, you can purchase one directly from Cambridge.
- If you have questions about billing, you can email assist@cubookstore.com

Canvas Usage

- All course materials will be posted on Canvas
- Check Canvas regularly for:
 - Class notes & Slides
 - PlayPosit videos
 - Homework assignments
 - Additional readings or in-class assignments

- Other important information
- Need help? Contact IT Service Center: help@colorado.edu or (303)735-4357

Class Preparation

To succeed in this course:

1. Watch short videos (10-15 minutes) **the day before each class**
2. Complete PlayPosit questions related to the videos (for a grade)
3. Attend live classes, which build on the video content
4. Use additional resources:
 - Textbook readings
 - Summary videos
 - In-Class problems
 - Office hours with TAs and/or instructor

Important: Keeping up with the class pace is crucial. This course is not suitable for last-minute cramming.

Generative AI Use Policy (Optional Learning Support)

At Leeds, we support the ethical and purposeful use of generative AI tools (such as ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Grammarly, NotebookLM, etc.) to enhance learning and develop critical thinking skills. When used appropriately, these tools can help you better understand complex material, explore alternative perspectives, and improve how you engage with course content.

Here are the key points to consider:

1. Student responsibilities:
 - Ensure alignment with course materials and textbook content – Accounting is taught in different ways, and there is a risk of receiving answers that do not align with the textbook
 - Verify the accuracy of AI-generated information
 - Understand that AI can make mistakes, especially in accounting
2. Permitted uses:
 - Assistance understanding concepts (ChatGPT and Gemini have “learning” features that are very effective)
 - Supplementing understanding while completing homework (at your own risk)
 - Use AI tools to ask better questions, test assumptions, and deepen insights, not to shortcut assignments.
3. Prohibited uses:
 - Completing homework assignments
 - Assisting with exams
 - Solving problems directly
4. Academic integrity:
 - Unauthorized use of AI tools will be treated as an academic integrity violation. Use of AI or assist with an exam is considered a violation.
5. Consultation:
 - If unsure about appropriate AI use or information provided, consult your instructor.

This policy aims to balance the benefits of AI with the development of fundamental skills and knowledge. Always prioritize understanding the material as taught in class and in the textbook.

Integrity & Academic Dishonesty: The integrity of the course depends on the integrity of each of us. We have an obligation to bring the best of ourselves and help those around us maintain a high degree of honesty. In this class, academic dishonesty will not be tolerated. It can have an adverse effect on other student's grades if a curve is deemed necessary. Additionally, it can encourage others to take short cuts if they believe others are doing the same. I expect each of you to do your work with honesty and integrity. You may not

gain, nor provide, assistance to others that may offer an unfair advantage in any way. This applies to large assignments and small assignments alike.

Because of the possible adverse effects on others, if you become aware of any form of academic dishonesty, it is your responsibility to inform me. Your anonymity will be respected, if you wish. This is not about "ratting out" your classmates, it is about helping to ensure the integrity of the class, the integrity of Leeds and it helps to ensure that students who graduate from Leeds have demonstrated a strong character.

If you cheat on **any** graded component of this course, you will receive a zero for that graded item. You may receive other academic sanctions, up to and including failing the course, and/or other non-academic sanctions that may be issued by the CU Honor Code Office. If you have any questions throughout the semester, please reach out to me.

Grading Breakdown:

<u>Activity</u>	<u>Percentage</u>
Homework (11)	25%
Pre-class PlayPosit	10%
Midterm Exam #1: See course calendar for date	15%
Midterm Exam #2: See course calendar for date	15%
Midterm Exam #3: See course calendar for date	15%
Final Exam (dates and times TBD, as set by the University)	20%

Homework Policy

- Graded assignments will be available for most topics
- Access assignments through Canvas (publisher's textbook site: MyBusinessCourse)
- Assignment updates or changes will be posted on Canvas
- Collaboration:
 - You may work with other students, tutors or TAs to better understand concepts.
 - You may use generative AI to understand concepts, knowing that there may be errors.
 - Each student must submit their own work through MyBusinessCourse
- Submission:
 - Due by 11:59 pm on the assigned date
 - Three attempts allowed per assignment
 - Late submissions receive **zero points**
- Grading:
 - Your lowest score will be dropped at the end of the semester
 - This provides one "free pass" - use it wisely

Pre-class PlayPosit Video Assignments

- Watch short, pre-recorded videos before each class (One Attempt)
- Videos contain embedded PlayPosit questions
- Submission:
 - ***Due by 11:59 pm prior to the related class day (See calendar)***
 - The video can be played once for credit, however each question can be answered up to two times, if the first answer is incorrect.
- Grading:
 - Full credit for on-time submissions

- Late submissions: 20% penalty per day
- Zero credit after five days
- Lowest score dropped at semester end (one "free pass")

Exam Policy

Midterm exams are in-class and in-person, and will include both multiple-choice questions and extended problems that require showing work (for possible partial credit). Each exam is designed for 70 minutes within a 75-minute class period, leaving 5 minutes for exam logistics.

Exam Format and Instructions:

- Students should record their multiple-choice answers directly on the scantron sheet as they work through the exam.
- All multiple-choice answers must also be circled in the exam booklet as a backup.

Exam Penalties:

- Continuing to work on extended problems after the stop announcement will result in an automatic 5-point deduction.
- If a student continues to work on the exam after the 5-point deduction, the exam will not be accepted.
- Failure to properly bubble answers on the scantron may result in lost credit if responses cannot be verified.

Exam Grading:

- The scantron sheet will serve as the official record for grading multiple-choice questions.
- The exam booklet will be used to grade the extended problems, and only as a backup for multiple-choice answers if verification is required by the instructor.

Exam Schedule:

- Three midterms and one final exam
- Midterms: In-Class during your normal class period
- Midterm Makeups: If you are sick, or have a university excused absence, you may take a makeup exam on the Saturday following the exam
- Final exam: Per University schedule

Exam Content:

- Covers multiple chapters from the textbook, pre-class videos, assigned readings, in-class material, and lecture slides

Midterm Exam Replacement Policy:

- If you miss a midterm exam and the makeup, you will receive a zero (0) and the final exam score will replace the midterm score
- Final exam score replaces lower midterm score(s) if higher
 - Example: You score a 70% on Midterm 1, a 75% on midterm 2, and a 90% on midterm 3, and then an 80% on the final. Your midterm 1 and 2 scores will change to 80%, because the final was higher.

Allowed Materials:

- Calculator of your choosing (No Cell Phones)
- Midterms: 1 page of notes (ONE SIDE ONLY)
- Final exam: 2 pages of notes (front and back)
- Excel: You may **not** use Excel on your exams.

Restrictions:

- No outside help (internet, texting, phone calls, in-person communications, No AI)

Student Responsibility:

- Arrange to attend each exam as scheduled
- If you have accommodations, you may be required to schedule your exam with the testing center or the disability services office.

Grade Appeals/Changes: If you believe an error has been made in grading or recording grades you must submit a written request within one week of when the assignment/exam score is made available.

Class participation: Student participation, in the form of both questions and comments, has historically made for a more interesting class and ensures that the class is going at an acceptable pace. Although participation is not an explicit component of the final grade, I may take it into account when I determine course grades for students at the grade cut-offs.

E-mail and Class Notices: All official course communication must be sent via official University of Colorado communication channels. Emails about course topics will be sent to your colorado.edu email accounts. If you use an email account other than an official university account, you are responsible for obtaining your email (through forwarding, for example).

SYLLABUS STATEMENTS

Honor Code

All students enrolled in a University of Colorado Boulder course are responsible for knowing and adhering to the [Honor Code](#). Violations of the Honor Code may include but are not limited to: plagiarism (including use of paper writing services or technology [such as essay bots]), cheating, fabrication, lying, bribery, threat, unauthorized access to academic materials, clicker fraud, submitting the same or similar work in more than one course without permission from all course instructors involved, and aiding academic dishonesty. Understanding the course's syllabus is a vital part of adhering to the Honor Code. All incidents of academic misconduct will be reported to Student Conduct & Conflict Resolution: StudentConduct@colorado.edu. Students found responsible for violating the Honor Code will be assigned resolution outcomes from Student Conduct & Conflict Resolution and will be subject to academic sanctions from the faculty member. Visit [Honor Code](#) for more information on the academic integrity policy.

Accommodation for Disabilities, Temporary Medical Conditions, and Medical Isolation

If you qualify for accommodations because of a disability, please submit your accommodation letter from Disability Services to your faculty member in a timely manner so that your needs can be addressed. Disability Services determines accommodations based on documented disabilities in the academic environment. Information on requesting accommodations is located on the [Disability Services website](#). Contact Disability Services at 303-492-8671 or DSinfo@colorado.edu for further assistance. If you have a temporary medical condition, see [Temporary Medical Conditions](#) on the Disability Services website.

If you have a temporary illness, injury or required medical isolation for which you require adjustment, please let me know as soon as possible. The course policies are designed to accommodate short-term illnesses (e.g., dropping the lowest homework and PlayPosit, shifting midterm weights to the final exam). If longer term accommodations are necessary, please schedule a meeting with me to discuss options.

Accommodation for Religious Obligations

Campus policy requires faculty to provide reasonable accommodations for students who, because of religious obligations, have conflicts with scheduled exams, assignments, or required attendance. Please communicate the need for a religious accommodation in a timely manner. In this class, policies are designed to accommodate religious conflicts. Homework and PlayPosit assignments can be completed in advance. Midterms have a makeup day, and exam weights can be shifted to the final exam if a student is unable to attend a scheduled midterm.

See the [campus policy regarding religious observances](#) for full details.

Preferred Student Names and Pronouns

CU Boulder recognizes that students' legal information does not always align with how they identify. If you wish to have your preferred name (rather than your legal name) and/or your preferred pronouns appear on your instructors' class rosters and in Canvas, visit the [Registrar's website](#) for instructions on how to change your personal information in university systems.

Classroom Behavior

Students and faculty are responsible for maintaining an appropriate learning environment in all instructional settings, whether in person, remote, or online. Failure to adhere to such behavioral standards may be subject to discipline. Professional courtesy and sensitivity are especially important with respect to individuals and topics dealing with race, color, national origin, sex, pregnancy, age, disability, creed, religion, sexual orientation, gender identity, gender expression, veteran status, marital status, political affiliation, or political philosophy.

Additional classroom behavior information

- [Student Classroom and Course-Related Behavior Policy.](#)
- [Student Code of Conduct.](#)
- [Office of Institutional Equity and Compliance.](#)
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Sexual Misconduct, Discrimination, Harassment and/or Related Retaliation

CU Boulder is committed to fostering an inclusive and welcoming learning, working, and living environment. University policy prohibits [protected-class](#) discrimination and harassment, sexual misconduct (harassment, exploitation, and assault), intimate partner abuse (dating or domestic violence), stalking, and related retaliation by or against members of our community on- and off-campus. The Office of Institutional Equity and Compliance (OIEC) addresses these concerns, and individuals who have been subjected to misconduct can contact OIEC at 303-492-2127 or email OIEC@colorado.edu. Information about university policies, [reporting options](#), and [OIEC support resources](#) including confidential services can be found on the [OIEC website](#).

Please know that faculty and graduate instructors are required to inform OIEC when they are made aware of incidents related to these concerns regardless of when or where something occurred. This is to ensure the person impacted receives outreach from OIEC about resolution options and support resources. To learn more about reporting and support a variety of concerns, visit the [Don't Ignore It page](#).

Mental Health and Wellness

The University of Colorado Boulder is committed to the well-being of all students. If you are struggling with personal stressors, mental health or substance use concerns that are impacting academic or daily life, please contact [Counseling and Psychiatric Services \(CAPS\)](#), located in C4C, or call (303) 492-2277, 24/7.